

The Noble Great Cloud

Ārya Mahāmegha · Toh 657 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 657 in the Kangyur is known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Mahāmegha and in Tibetan as the Phags pa sprin chen po, rendered in English as The Noble Great Cloud. It is a Mahāyāna sūtra set dramatically in the palace of the nāga king Nanda, where the Buddha addresses a vast assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, and nāga kings, suggesting that its concerns include the nāga world, the powers associated with rain and clouds, and the spiritual blessings that flow from these forces. The text belongs to the general class of sūtra literature within the Kangyur, the canonical collection of the Buddha's translated words, and its elaborate opening assembly scene — replete with named nāga lords and a jeweled cloud maṇḍala mansion — signals the rich cosmological and protective dimensions characteristic of this genre.

In the language of India: Ārya Mahāmegha. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Cloud.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the palace of the nāga king Nanda, in the pleasure grove of the nāga king Nanda and Upananda, within the great cloud maṇḍala mansion whose essence is the glory of precious jewels. He was accompanied by a great Saṅgha of monks, a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, and a great assembly of nāga kings, namely: the nāga king Nanda, Upananda, Sāgara, Anavatapta, Tejin, Varuṇa, Sthira, Dhṛtarāṣṭra, Dhanada's son, the nāga king Takṣaka, Pṛthivīpāla's son, Mudgara, Śrīteja, Śrībhadrā, Vidyullatā, Maṇisīraḥ, Maṇidhara, Prabhāśikhara, Śikhāvinda, and the nāga king Indradhvaja, Indrapūjita, Jambūdhvaja, Maṅgalin, Mahāmaṇḍala, Mahāhasta, Nakṣatravat, Candrateja, Śrīmatī, Candradarśin, the nāga king Sudarśana, Sthirātman, Kaṇṭhamaṇi, Meghaja, Dhārādhara, Prabhañjana, Viprabhañjana, Tejodbhava, Mahāgarvita, Gambhīraghoṣa, and the nāga king Mahāghoṣa, Vimalaghona, Utpala, Mahābala, Ārakadhara, Nānasena, Mahāpāśa, and the nāga king Elāpattrā, Sarvābhāsa, Karkaśakarṇa, Śaṅkha, Dardara, the nāga king Upadardara, Sukhaṅkara, Hastatāra, Mahāhastatāra, Mahāmala, Uddīna, Niśśalya, Lambaka, Kṛmīsthāna, Kṛṣṇa, and the nāga king Indrasena, Kardama, Upakardama, Śaṅkhadhara, Kheḍin, Suprabha, Hastin, Tīkṣṇa, Pītaśyāma, Vidyulpradīpa, Mahāvidyulprabha, Balādhideva, Udakabala,

and the nāga king Uttamaprāvṛta, Amṛtin, Tīrthika, Vaiḍūryaraśmi, Suvarṇaghoṣa, Suvarṇaprabha, Candradhvajaraśmi, Sūryaraśmi, Udaya, Vatsaśirā, and the nāga king Śveta, Kṛṣṇa, Yama, Śīlavat, Maṇḍūka, Haṃsateja, Valayindhara, Dhāraṇidhara, Sahasraśirā, Cūḍāmaṇi, and the nāga king Arthādarśin, Mahāmegha, Susena, Bhūpāla, Manuṣyada, Sudānta, Prītyutpāda, Kumbhīramukha, Viśadhara, and the nāga king Kṣipratīkṣṇa, Padmaka, Pucchin, Prasārin, Bhayankaraḥ, Tejomanorama, Pañcaśirā, Vallīra, Syandanajita, and the nāga king Guru, the nāga king Dīrghapucchin, Mahāśirā, Pimbika, Vitara, Kṣipragāmin, and the nāga king Triśirā, Nāgasena, Mahāteja, Kardamadatta, and the nāga king Trāsin, Prabhādīpta, Saptaśirā, Mahāsahasra, Priyadarśana, Mahāpratāpa, Nirmalaśrī, Nayanaśobhana, Mahākrodha, Prabhāskandha, and the nāga king Pracaṇḍa, Krodhavegaśālin, Ratnadāna, Ratnadānamahāmegha, and Indratejas —

Pādapa, Megha, Sāgaramegha, Puṣpamahāgandha, Kumudākarā, and the nāga king Ratnanetra, Mahāketuvijaya, Mahāmeghahṛdaya, Himavat, Śrīhṛdaya, Meghavīrya, Rātriṃdhara, Udadatta, Mahodadatta, and the nāga king Tejaḥsadṛśāgni, Meghaiśvararāja, Akrodha, Bhūmikumbha, Nāgaśrī, Udadhara, Meghacchatra, Aṅgāramukha, Tejasvin, Meghābhijāta, and the nāga queen Anantavikrama, Rūpasampanna, Mahākāya, Sphitoḍara, Śānta, Śūra, Suvarṇagandha, Paramodyukta, Viṣaṇī, Svaraghoṣa, and the nāga king Amṛtahṛdaya, Mahāpravarṣin, Vicalana, Meghasvara, Dundubhisvara, Amṛtadhārā, Pramodaka, Meghanadita, Vīrasena, Nāgasena, Sāgarāvarta, and the nāga king Kubjaka — all these great nāga kings and eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of nāgas assembled together and were present.

At that time those nāga kings, together with their retinues, rose from their seats, arranged their robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, and, turning with palms joined toward the Blessed One, offered him profound reverence and deep prostrations. They presented to the Blessed One flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, garments, parasols, victory banners, flags, silk streamers, the sound of music, cymbals, the beating of drums, song and melody, jeweled flowers, jeweled streamers, pearl garlands, nāga flowers, and supremely beautiful nets of pearl — offerings various, immeasurable, and beyond counting. Having presented these, they circumambulated him and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, they then offered aspiration prayers:

May bodies as vast as oceans, equal in number to the finest atoms of all world-system oceans, be present within each and every maṇḍala-ocean of the assemblies of buddhas and bodhisattvas, within all the boundlessly vast oceans of world-systems, and within each finest atom of all earth, water, fire, and wind, and within each finest atom of all that appears as form. And from each and every one of those finest atoms, may there arise clouds of body-oceans — perfectly transcending all countable oceans of bodies — numberless, immeasurable, inconceivable, incomparable, beyond measure, beyond expression, utterly transcendent. And from each such body, may there stream forth immeasurable and numberless clouds of hand-oceans, blessed and flowing in continuous torrents in every direction, so that from each and every atom, distinct, non-intermingled clouds of oceans of all offerings, spreading to fill the ground of every direction, may make offerings to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. Such is our aspiration: that immeasurable, numberless, inconceivable, beyond measure, without limit, and beyond expression distinct non-intermingled cloud-oceans of bodies of universal conduct, blessed so as to cover all of space, and clouds of bodhisattva body-oceans — even as they truly are — together with the dense colors and light-rays of all precious jewels, bodies like all suns and moons, and clouds of oceans of retinue-maṇḍalas of bodies —

— clouds of oceans of garlands of all precious jewels and of flowers; clouds of oceans of palace towers that are the essence of the great brilliance of all precious jewels; clouds of oceans of treasures of all powders and all wish-granting trees; clouds of oceans of forms that manifest all incense and all perfume; clouds of oceans of musical sounds that resound with every sound; clouds of oceans of wish-granting trees of all fragrances — all these, blessed so as to cover the entire space of the sky, together with all clouds of oceans of every offering, immeasurable, numberless, inconceivable, beyond measure, without limit, and beyond expression, distinct and non-intermingled: may they render homage, act as supreme objects of reverence, offer praise, and make offerings to all the oceans of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of jewel-kings that are the essence of illuminating radiance, arrayed and made brilliant throughout all realms — blessed so as to cover the entire space of the sky — may they render homage, act as supreme objects of reverence, offer praise, and make offerings to all the oceans of buddhas and bodhisattvas. Together with clouds of oceans of jewel-kings, arrayed with the rain of all-illuminating precious jewel-rains; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings of

melody, endowed with blazing light-rays radiating from all precious jewels, whose sound is determined to reach the buddhas; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings of melodious voice, resounding everywhere with the voices of all dharmas of the buddhas; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings whose light-rays from every precious door illumine the emanations of the buddhas; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings that display all appearances throughout the distinct non-intermingled maṇḍalas of the retinue, with all their adornments displayed; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings of radiant lamplight, following in the wake of all the buddha-realms; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings that display the appearances of the Tathāgata's measureless palaces throughout the inconceivable buddha-realms; clouds of oceans of jewel-kings that manifest and make apparent the body of buddhas of the three times within the dust-motes of every variety of precious jewel — all these, blessed so as to cover the entire space of the sky, may they render homage, act as supreme objects of reverence, offer praise, and make offerings to all the oceans of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of distinct, non-intermingled palace towers of all precious jewels, incense, and every variety of flowers; clouds of oceans of palace towers magnificently adorned with jewel-kings of every boundless color; clouds of oceans of palace towers radiant with jeweled lamps and the light of incense; clouds of oceans of palace towers adorned throughout with all manner of pearls; clouds of oceans of the pollen of all flowers; clouds of oceans of palace towers beautifully adorned with endless garlands of precious jewels — all these, blessed so as to cover the entire space of the sky, together with clouds of oceans of palace towers that are the essence of light-ray brilliance spreading through all ten directions, perfectly gathering all adornments; clouds of oceans of palace towers displaying throughout their many fine arrangements adorned with the dust of all precious jewels; clouds of oceans of palace towers completely filled and flourishing with every adornment —

clouds of oceans of flower-stairways with networks of bells resounding at every gate, blessed so as to cover all the space of the sky in every direction, offered as a place of honor, as something supreme, as an image, and as a gift to all the oceans of buddhas and bodhisattvas;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of gold and various precious jewels in clusters and garlands, and whose hearts are jeweled necklaces;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses various as the appearance of flowers;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses of the gold of the Anavatapta and Jambū rivers, various in kind;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses that are lamps of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses that are victory banners blazing with the light of precious jewels, various in kind;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses adorned with precious jewels, various in kind;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses possessed of light-rays that blaze with the beauty of Anavatapta;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses possessed of majesty with blazing rays of light that are inexhaustible;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses from which all blazing precious jewels have arisen;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses from which all the most supreme blazing precious jewels have arisen;

clouds of oceans of unmixed lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses possessed of the light-rays of the voice-sound of the buddhas —

all these blessed so as to cover all the space of the sky in every direction, offered as a place of honor, as something supreme, as an image, and as a gift to all the oceans of buddhas and bodhisattvas;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees of incense and of all manner of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of incense jewel-trees from whose every gate-leaf clouds arise as though with palms joined together;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees everywhere displaying the endless forms of all jewel-trees arranged together;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees from which hang cascading clouds of all flowers;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees possessed of inexhaustible treasures from which all adornments arise;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees that illuminate the maṇḍalas of all radiant precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees everywhere displaying the powder of all sandalwood as half-body of a bodhisattva;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees that are like suns illuminating a treasury of all precious garments, trees possessed of inconceivable luminosity displaying the adornments of all awakening-hearts;

clouds of oceans of jewel-trees that proclaim all sounds and melodies, releasing every pleasing tone;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of lotuses of endless colors of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence illuminates the king of jewels that projects everywhere and appears on all sides;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is completely adorned with every adornment and arrangement;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is a garland of lamps from which rays of light stream in all manner of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of precious sound jewel-trees arising on every side;

along with incense, and flowers, and

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is a garland of all lotuses made of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is the king of precious jewels that displays everywhere the arranged seats of all buddhas;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is a cloud of precious jewels, supremely adorned with stairways and platforms hung with garlands of every adornment;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence is made of all manner of trunks bearing branches of precious jewels and repositories of fine dust;

clouds of oceans of lion thrones whose essence makes sunlight shine, adorned on every side with nets of swinging precious jewel bells, together with all manner of incense —

all these consecrated and covering the entire expanse of the sky, so as to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of palatial mansions of all wish-fulfilling jewel kings;

clouds of oceans of canopies of every adornment of flowers with anthers of indranīla;

clouds of oceans of canopies of all incense and precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of canopies in the form of lamps radiating light from precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of canopies of melodious jewel kings that appear to display the miraculous powers of the buddhas;

clouds of oceans of canopies that display everywhere the light of every adornment of garments of various precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of precious jewel canopies that appear as blazing rivers of all flowers;

clouds of oceans of canopies of nets filled and spread everywhere with the sounds of various bells;

clouds of oceans of canopies of lotus nets whose essence is precious jewels, appearing in various ways as blazing lotuses of endless colors;

clouds of oceans of canopies of victory banners appearing as rays of light from nets of gold;

clouds of oceans of canopies of adornments of every adornment, spread with endless rays of light appearing as inconceivable arrangements —

all these consecrated and covering the entire expanse of the sky, so as to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of vast ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of parasols of all manner of various precious jewels consecrated and covering the entire expanse of the sky;

clouds of oceans of flower parasols arranged with the radiant light of the ten precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of parasols of treasures of pearls of endless colors;

clouds of oceans of parasols of jewel kings whose sound opens the gateway of compassion of all buddhas and bodhisattvas;

clouds of oceans of parasols of garlands radiating light from various precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of parasols of hanging nets of bells supremely adorned with the radiant dust of precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of parasols adorned with branches and boughs of all jewel trees;

clouds of oceans of parasols of all incense and perfumes together with jewel kings that radiate light making the sun shine brightly;

clouds of oceans of parasols filled and spread everywhere with treasures of sandalwood powder;

these unmixed clouds of oceans of parasols, filled and spread everywhere with every vast array that illuminates the great buddha-fields —

with all these, to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas radiating the light of all precious jewels;

unmixed clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of the light of the forms of all radiating precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light that illuminate with clouds of flowers;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light endowed with maṇḍalas of light that are emanations of buddhas, born from the rays of all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light that illuminate all the buddha-fields, pervading them with radiance;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light of jewel-tree boughs that proclaim the realm of buddhas everywhere through every gateway;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light of the rays of vaidūrya, of all kinds of precious jewels, of all kinds of precious gems, and of all jewel kings;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light that display, in a single instant of mind, the boundless forms of all sentient beings;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light endowed with the utterly pleasing sounds born from the aspirations of all buddhas;

and clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light of melodious jewel kings — those that tame sentient beings throughout all surrounding maṇḍala-realms —

with all these, to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Clouds of oceans of rays of light from the treasuries of all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of rays of the forms, sounds, fragrances, tastes, and tactile qualities of all buddhas;

clouds of oceans of rays radiating from all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of rays that fill and spread widely the proclamation of the Dharma of all buddhas;

clouds of oceans of rays that illuminate all the arranged splendors of the buddha-fields;

clouds of oceans of rays of all towering palaces of flowers;

clouds of oceans of rays of the dust of all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of rays, resounding with the proclamation that buddhas

appear throughout every successive age, ripening all sentient beings to full maturation;

clouds of oceans of rays of the stamens of all flowers, displaying all inexhaustible precious jewels;

and unmixed clouds of oceans of rays that display everywhere every arranged throne and seat —

with all these, to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Unmixed clouds of oceans of the boundless colors of radiating precious jewel light;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of all-pervasive jewel kings of light;

clouds of oceans of radiating light that illuminate the vast arranged splendors of all the buddha-fields;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of all incenses;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of every kind of adornment;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of the emanations of all buddhas;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of the stamens of all manner of jewel trees;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of every garment;

clouds of oceans of radiating light of melodious jewel kings expressing the boundless conduct of bodhisattvas;

and unmixed clouds of oceans of radiating light of all pearl lamps —

with all these, to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas throughout the vast ocean of clouds of the great ocean.

Inconceivable clouds of oceans of every variety of incense and flowers;

clouds of oceans of lotus-net arrays radiating light from all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of maṇḍalas of light of boundless colors of precious jewel-gems;

clouds of oceans of treasures of pearls adorned with the colors of all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of powdered dust of every precious jewel, incense, and sandalwood;

clouds of oceans of parasols of all precious jewels;

clouds of oceans of melodious jewel-kings, pleasing, lovely, and beautiful in voice;

clouds of oceans of garlands of masses of sun-radiance jewels;

clouds of oceans of boundless treasures of precious jewels;
and unmixed clouds of oceans of the bodies of Samantabhadra throughout all things —

with all these, to pay homage, to exalt, to portray, and to make offering to all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas throughout the vast ocean of clouds of the great ocean.

Having made aspirational prayers of this kind, those nāga kings then circumambulated the Blessed One three times, prostrated at his feet, and, the Blessed One having given his permission, each took their seat.

At that time, the great lord of nāgas of the great trichiliocosm, endowed with the power of irreversible aspiration, arrayed with an ocean-cloud retinue of infinite attendants, the one called King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants, had come to this Jambudvīpa in order to make offering to, pay homage to, honor, and hear the Dharma from the Tathāgata.

Then the nāga lord, King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants, rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and, joining his palms and bowing in the direction where the Blessed One was, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "If the Blessed One would grant me the opportunity to ask and to receive a prophetic declaration in answer to my request, I would ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, something on my behalf."

When this was said, the Blessed One declared to the nāga lord, King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants: "Nāga lord, ask whatever you wish, and I shall gladden your heart by prophetically declaring the answer to whatever you ask."

When this was declared, the nāga lord, King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, how may the stream of all suffering of all nāgas be cut off? How may they come to be endowed with every happiness and become thoroughly joyful? How may the rains fall in regular streams here in Jambudvīpa at the proper times? How may all grasses, trees, herbs, and forests grow? How may all crops arise? How may all vital essences arise rightly? And how may the people of Jambudvīpa come to be endowed

with happiness?"

When this was said, the Blessed One declared to the nāga lord, King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants: "Nāga lord, it is excellent, excellent that you, having entered for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, intend to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. Therefore, nāga lord, listen well, take it to heart,

and I shall explain it to you. Nāga lord, if one is endowed with a single quality, all the nāga sufferings of all nāgas will be cut off without remainder, and they will come to be endowed with happiness. What is that one quality? It is this: loving-kindness (maitrī).

Nāga lord, gods and humans who abide in loving-kindness will not be burned by fire, will not be overcome by weapons, will not be swept away by water, will not be overcome by poison, and will not be overpowered by the armies of enemies. They will lie down in happiness and will awaken in happiness. They will be fully protected by their own merit. By great merit they will be resplendent with majesty. They will not be looked down upon by the world with its gods. They will be beautiful and pleasing to behold. They will be unobstructed in all their paths of travel. All their sufferings will be cut off without remainder, and they will be supremely joyful. They will be endowed with all happiness, and having realized the highest human Dharma, after the dissolution of the body they will be reborn in the Brahma world. Nāga lord, these are the benefits for gods and humans who abide in loving-kindness.

Nāga lord, therefore one should abide by the bodily actions of loving-kindness, the verbal actions of loving-kindness, and the mental actions of loving-kindness.

Nāga lord, furthermore, the dhāraṇī called Bestower of All Happiness is to be recited. It cuts off without remainder all the nāga sufferings of all nāgas, and it bestows all happiness. It causes the rains to fall in their proper seasons upon this Jambudvīpa, and it causes all grasses, creeping plants, herbs, forests, and crops to grow. Nāga lord, what is the dhāraṇī called Bestower of All Happiness? It is this:

tadyathā dhāraṇī dhāraṇī uttāraṇī saṃpratiṣṭhite vijayavarṇa
satyapratimjñāsaraha jñānavati uddepādani vināmani abhiṣecani abhivyāhāra
śubhavati ajimatu ehi kumabalaṇi bahahāra kleśana dhunapāpaṃ śodhaya
mārgaṇa niratika dharmatāśuddha lokavitimirarajasa duḥkhaśamana
sarvabuddha avalokana adhiṣṭhiti prajñājñānavisvāhā.

Nāga lord, this dhāraṇī, which accomplishes all the meanings of the dhāraṇī's words, which enters into the dharmakāya, and which has been blessed by all buddhas — this Bestower of All Happiness — is to be held and to be recited.

Nāga lord, furthermore, the blessed and arranged majestic essence arisen from the class of clouds, which makes itself appear as an emanation, which is the glorious cloud-maṇḍala of the stream of waters that is the crest of wisdom, which illuminates with golden rays — the names of the bones arisen from the tips of a single hair and of the Tathāgatas of those lineages are to be grasped and kept in mind. These cut off without remainder all the nāga sufferings of all nāgas, all nāga lineages, all nāga clans, all nāga families, all nāga elements, all nāga birth-places, all nāga kings, all nāga daughters, and all nāga attendants, and they accomplish all the requisites of happiness.

Nāga lord, what are those names of the Tathāgatas? They are these:

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Great Cloud of the Essential Vairocana.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who is beautified by clouds arisen from the nāga lineage.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud-Holder of Water.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Glorious Majestic Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, from whom the Great Cloud arises.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud that Utterly Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of Rivers.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Immeasurable Sky.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Assembly of Blazing Lightning of the Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Heroic One of Mighty Power of the Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Beautiful Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Gatherer of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Maṇḍala of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Light of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Lion.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Canopy.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Lovely Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Covered by the Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who proclaims with supreme excellence the drum-sound resounding to the ten directions, the illuminating maṇḍala arisen from clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud of Cool Arising, utterly destroying misery, resounding with profound sound.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Glorious Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud of the Waters of the Ganges.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Heroic One like a Cloud of Power.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Proclaimer of Thunder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who fully reveals the Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Vast Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Dripping Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who resounds like a Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who is exalted like a Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who is clothed in garments like clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud that Causes Harvests to Grow.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who dwells in the abode of clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud of Rain Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who causes clouds to gather.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Fully Expansive Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Utpala.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud of Fragrant Body.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who is exalted like a Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Sovereign.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Maker of Light.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Splendor.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who is like a Cloud of Great Precious Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who utterly destroys like a Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, River of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Gatherer of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who utterly destroys unseasonable clouds and hailstorms.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who proclaims from on high in the

sky like a Great Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud that Sends Forth Sound.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud Born of Rain.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Cloud that Accomplishes Majestic Splendor.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud of Water Endowed with the Six Tastes.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud that Scatters Rain.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Great Cloud that Fills the Ocean.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, who when rain does not fall covers everything with clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, whose cloud forms are boundless.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, who accomplishes all great clouds, who is the Splendor of the Cloud of Jambudvīpa, who is Maker of Glorious Light, and who possesses rays of cloud light.

By the recitation of these names of the Tathāgata, O Sovereign of Nāgas, all the suffering of all nāgas is cut off without remainder; they come to possess every happiness; and in this Jambudvīpa, at the proper seasons, a continuous rain falls and causes grasses, climbing plants, medicinal herbs, forests, and all manner of crops to grow and flourish.

Then the Sovereign of Nāgas of the great trichilocosm, King Canopy-like Majestic Splendor of the Array of Clouds of the Ocean of Boundless Retinue, made this entreaty to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, in the final age, at the final time, when in this Jambudvīpa rain does not fall — what should be recited so that a great continuous rain will pour down? And in times of terrible calamity, in times when harm arises, in times when people fall into conflict through what is contrary to Dharma, in times of epidemic disease and of arising harm, in times of illness and death, in times when malevolent stars are in place, in times of epidemic disease, violence, and every kind of harm — what will utterly pacify all of these? And the foundations of the dhāraṇī mantras that properly urge forth all nāgas, that cause all the gods to rejoice greatly, that utterly vanquish all māras, that dispel every fear of all sentient beings, that avert every harm, that bring peace and all good fortune, that utterly pacify whatever has been wrought by malevolent stars, and that clear away all five obstacles to rain that the Blessed One has spoken of, and that

cause a good continuous rain to fall in this Jambudvīpa — may the Blessed One, who is supreme in compassion, who is filled with loving care for the benefit of all sentient beings, please expound the foundations of such dhāraṇī mantras and bestow the blessing of the buddhas upon them. We beseech the Blessed One, the Tathāgata." When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to King Canopy-like Majestic Splendor of the Array of Clouds of the Ocean of Boundless Retinue, Sovereign of Nāga Kings, the following: "Excellent! Excellent, Sovereign of Nāgas! It is well that you have entreated the Tathāgata for the sake of benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Therefore, Sovereign of Nāgas, listen well and hold this in mind. This dhāraṇī, born of great compassion, named the Heroic Pinnacle, which is endowed with the sound of a great thunder-dragon — for the sake, the benefit, and the

happiness of all beings — has been spoken by all the buddhas and blessed by them. I will now set forth their joyful affirmation of it. This dhāraṇī causes rain to fall in a time of no rain. It stops excessive rain. It thoroughly pacifies the harm of death. It stirs all nāgas to action. It satisfies all the gods. It utterly vanquishes all māras. It brings all sentient beings to possess every happiness.

Tadyathā: mahājñāna, avabhāsanī, śrītejorakṣmādrṣṭavikrama,
vajrasaṃhatane, paramavīrāja, nirmalagurṇaketusuryaprabhe,
vimalāṅgayaṣṭi, bhara bhara, saṃbhara saṃbhara, dudum̐bu, hana hana,
mahāprabhevidhātamahāmohaṃdhakare, prajñāgrasuddhe,
varipūraṇamaitre, maitrivīraṃskandha, maitremābuddhe, jvala jvala jvala,
jvalāṃbuddhe, jvalāṃbuddhe, jvalāṃbuddhe, bodhyaṃgakusumadaśabale,
caturvaiśāradye, aṣṭādaśa, aveṇikabuddhadharme, śubhamati, puṇyarāśi,
śukladhārmāsamanviti, gambhīre gambhīre, bhirajaske, vimalo, viśeṣa,
prāvate, nirāprabhādharme, sarvalokajyeṣṭhajyeṣṭha, parpravare, anuttare,
asaṃge, dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, śāntamate śāntamate, cara
cara, cara cara, ciri ciri, curu curu, paramabuddhānumite,
mahāprajñāpāramite svāhā.

Homage to the Tathāgata Vairocana, endowed with an ocean of gnosis.
Homage to all buddhas and all bodhisattvas.

Now, in order to bring rain down upon this Jambudvīpa, the essence of all nāgas is to be recited. By the truth of all buddhas and all bodhisattvas, may the five obstacles that hinder the rain be dispelled.

Syādyathaidan: sara sara, siri siri, suru suru, nāgānāṃ, java java, jivi jivi, jubu jubu — O great nāgas, come hither! By the truth of the buddhas, let rain pour

abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa. Cara cara, ciri ciri, curu curu — O great lords of nāgas, come hither! O great nāgas, by the truth of the buddhas, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa. Bara bara, biri biri, buru buru — by the truth of the buddhas, may all nāgas be summoned. With a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of compassion, a mind of joy, and a mind of equanimity, by the blessing, truth, and great intention of all the buddhas and all bodhisattvas — O lords of nāgas, come hither! Remember the buddhas, the Dharma of the buddhas, and the qualities of the bodhisattvas.

Bhara bhara, bhiri bhiri, bhuru bhuru — you great attendants of the mighty ones who carry the waters of great rivers and the waters of clouds, come hither with a mind of loving-kindness. Remember the sacred teaching of the Teacher.

Ghaḍa ghaḍa, ghiḍi ghiḍi, dhuḍu ghuḍu — you who are fierce, endowed with great wrathful power, you who thrust out your great venomous tongues — come hither with a mind of loving-kindness. By the truth of all the Tathāgatas, let rain fall upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā.

Taṭa taṭa, tiṭi tiṭi, tuṭu tuṭu — you who wear crowns of precious jewels, you who bear the forms of deadly serpents, call to mind the blessing of the Three Jewels, and by the truth of Vajradhara, let rain fall upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā.

Kala kala, kili kili, kulu kulu — you who dwell in great waters, who ride upon great masses of piled clouds, going forward upon your mounts — come hither! with a mind of loving-kindness, let streams of rain fall upon this Jambudvīpa. By the truth of the Tathāgatas and the blessing of the Tathāgatas, this is the charge given by Vajrapāṇi.

Rala rala, rili rili, rulu rulu — you who go by hand, all of you, be without sleep! By the truth of the Tathāgatas of the three times: ghama ghama, ghimi ghimi, ghumu ghumu svāhā. Let all nāgas be summoned!

With a mind of loving-kindness, led forward by the awakening mind: nara nara, niri niri, nuru nuru svāhā. Let there be summoned the great serpents with their many-colored crests, their many heads, with red heads and red eyes, the great mighty serpents of great power.

Kye kye! You great ones who go by hand, you who are supremely compassionate, who blaze with the splendor of all merit, who are free from affliction — call to mind the blessing of the Tathāgatas. Gaḍa gaḍa, giḍi giḍi,

guḍu guḍu svāhā. You who are endowed with power, who overcome others, who bear unobstructed splendor — let streams of rain pour down upon this Jambudvīpa. Śara śara, śiri śiri, śuru śuru svāhā.

Kye kye! O great nāgas, call to mind your own lineages and your own clans — do not tarry! By the blessing of the truth of all the gods, let streams of rain pour down upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the blessing of the truth of Brahmā, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of Śakra, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of the Four Great Kings, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of the eight great nāgas, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of those great nāgas who are stream-enterers, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of those great nāgas who are once-returners, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of those great nāgas who are non-returners, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of those great nāgas who are arhats, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of those great nāgas who are pratyekabuddhas, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of all buddhas and bodhisattvas, O great nāgas, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. O great nāgas, by the truth and the blessing of all Tathāgatas, let rain pour mightily upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of all gods, let all harm be pacified svāhā. By the truth of all nāgas, let rain pour mightily upon this great earth svāhā. By the truth of all yakṣas, let all sentient beings be protected svāhā. By the truth of all gandharvas (scent-eaters), let all strife and harm among human beings be dispersed svāhā. By the truth of all asuras, let all inauspicious planetary conjunctions be utterly reversed svāhā. By the truth of all garuḍas (sky-soaring eagles), let all nāgas be brought to loving-kindness and let great streams of rain pour down upon this Jambudvīpa svāhā. By the truth of all kinnaras (half-human celestial musicians), let all evil be pacified svāhā. Let all sentient beings be satisfied svāhā. By the truth of all great serpents, in their breadth and vastness, let streams of rain pour down svāhā. Here, let the five obstacles to rain be perfectly seized and removed svāhā. By the truth of all human beings, let all human beings be fully protected svāhā.

Kara kara, kiri kiri, kuru kuru, dara dara, diri diri, duru duru, naṭa naṭa, niṭi niṭi, nuṭu nuṭu — O swift-moving one! O bearer of the waters of the great clouds! O cloud-bearer! O great cloud-bearer! O bearer of the waters of the great clouds! O radiant cloud! O cloud-arising one!

O lady of the seasonal clouds! O lady who is the source of clouds! O lady who proclaims with clouds! O lady who dwells in the clouds! O lady crowned with clouds! O lady who wears a garland of clouds! O lady adorned with clouds! O lady who is veiled by clouds! O lady who has taken up residence in the clouds! O cloud-haired one of the very essence of clouds! O lady who is the light of clouds! O lady possessed of a retinue of clouds! O lady who dwells in the vast clouds! O lady who holds clouds as an offering! O lady who brings about the ripening of crops! O lady who dwells in the mountain valleys! O Blessed Lady, mother of the nāgas! O glorious great-cloud one with a star-like hue! O lady of the cool touch! O lady who moves in the sphere of the great storm! O great nāga lady who takes delight! O Blessed Lady! O lady who takes hold of the six essences distilled from pontra! By the truth of the buddhas, let rain descend abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

Ghar ghar. Ghiri ghiri. Ghuru ghuru. Ghiri ni. Ghiri ni. Ghuma ghuma ghuma. Ghuma ghuma ghuma ri.

O lady possessed of nine heads! O lady who has a garland of clouds! O lady who has a garland of masses of lightning! O lady who holds all creatures with her hands! O lady who wears garments like clouds! O lady who moves in the sphere of all fierce poisons! O lady who rides upon an array of clouds! O lady who roars like thunder! O lady who proclaims with sound! O lady who rouses the assembly of nāgas! O goddess lady adorned with a great garland of clouds! Without withdrawing from all the nāgas, by the blessing of the Tathāgata, let rain fall upon this Jambudvīpa! So I entreat you — svāhā!

Yara yara. Yiri yiri. Yuru yuru. Jara jara. Jiri jiri. Juru juru. Jhara jhara. Guḍu guḍu. Gugu ḍu. Gaḍa gaḍa. Giḍi giḍi. Hara hara. Hili hili. Mulu mulu. Tala tala. Tili tili. Tulu tulu. Hana hana. Daha daha. Paca paca. Gṛhṇa gṛhṇa. Marda marda. Pramarda. Pravarsavighnān. Maitreyājñāpayati svāhā.

Buddhe buddhe. Bu buddhe. Bu buddhe. Hara pāpam. Sarva sattvānām. Aghisthiya paṇyama. Sarva buddhānām. Dhariṇi dhare. Śubhamate guṇāgra prāpaṇe. Mahājñāno. Lage. Śukla dharme satya patijñe. Mahāyānādhuṣṭitrai loka jyeṣṭha bhagavati. Buddha maitri āpūraya sarva kṣetrāṇi. Śukle śvetām. Varadate. Pantaravāsini. Dhudhure. Dhudhuru. Śama śama. Śānta manāse. Let all obstacles to rain be perfectly cleared away — svāhā!

By the truth of all Tathāgatas of the three times, with a mind of loving-kindness, with flawless discipline and the resolve of ascetic practice, I make perfect and proper entreaty to all the great nāgas.

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the great king of nāgas, glorious as the ocean with boundless attendants, whose majestic sovereignty is like a canopy of arranged clouds. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga kings Nandaka and Upanandaka. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Sāgara. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Anavatapta. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Tejin. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Varuṇa. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Elāpatra. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Virupākṣa. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king, son of Dhanaśrī. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Takṣaka. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king, son of Dharaṇī-Guardian.
Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Nutala. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Glorious Splendor. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Auspicious Glory. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Garland of Lightning. Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Great Jewel on the Crown.
Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Jewel-Holder on the Crown.
Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to the nāga king Luminous Topknot. Let
rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

I make perfect and proper entreaty to all the great nāga kings and all the rest.
Let rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

Nāge nāge, mahānāge, bhoramanase, nāgaḥṛdaya, dhūmākule, ugroroṣe
pracaṇḍateje, viṣoghre, aṣebhiṣe, ahigore, kṛṣṇapiṅgale, cañcale, lolajihve,
mahāphaṇakare, kalābhāṣe, raudrabhāseni, ḍuḍumave ghanaghaṇa, śikini,
kanakana, gaṇagaṇa, mahāgaṇagaṇi, parapara, piripiri, purupuru, visarjani,
bhurubhuru, mahābhoge, maṇidare, phiriphiri, phurūphurū, pharaphara, varṣa
varṣa, jalāmbudare, śambhuśambhu, vatatu ṭuma me, dhūṃdhūṃ,
dhūṃdhūṃbe, meghaprabhe, meghagrahiṇi, ḍhaka ḍhaka, ḍhakaḍhuḍhumbe,
ghanāghanā, śikini, kanakana, gaṇagaṇa, mahānāgagane, niratruṇṭu,
vajradharakari mahānādhidaye, ghumaghumā, ghumapayāstika,
jāṃgīribhujāṃgame, vikaṭasaṃkaṭe, goribhisphūrjani, bijṛmabhane — I invoke
all nāgas!

By the blessing of all the buddhas, by the truth of all the Tathāgatas of the
three times, and by the heart of loving-kindness, let rain fall abundantly upon
this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

Namaḥ sarvābuddhebhyaḥ siddhyantu, mantrapadāni svāhā!

This is the sixty-fourth chapter, called "The Maṇḍala of the Wind Circle that
Brings Down Rain," from the noble Great Cloud Sūtra of the Great Vehicle, in
one hundred thousand verses.

The ritual for one who wishes to bring down heavy rain is as follows. In a clean
outdoor place with unobstructed sky, one sets out a blue cushion and hangs
up a blue banner. The Dharma-teacher bathes, remains near the octagonal
bathing pool, dresses in clean blue garments, anoints himself with sweet
incense, eats the three white foods, and then sits upon a blue seat. Facing
east, he makes supplication to all the Tathāgatas, and reads this chapter of
the Maṇḍala of the Great Cloud continuously, without interruption, day and
night. He places four vases filled with blue water that have been consecrated.
He also prepares, to the best of his ability, torma offerings, incense, and

flowers.

The Dharma-teacher then draws with black ink in the four directions as follows. To the east, at a distance of about three arm-lengths, he draws a three-headed nāga king together with a retinue of various nāga attendants. To the south, at a distance of about five arm-lengths, he draws a five-headed nāga king together with a retinue of various nāga attendants. To the west, at a distance of about seven arm-lengths, he draws a seven-headed nāga king together with a retinue of various nāga attendants.

To the north, at a distance of about nine arm-lengths, he draws a nine-headed nāga king together with a retinue of various nāga attendants.

The Dharma-teacher then guards his body and abides in loving-kindness, settles his mind in compassion toward all sentient beings, makes supplication to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, and shares the roots of virtue with the nāgas. This is the ritual procedure.

Whoever reads this chapter on the wind-maṇḍala of the Great Cloud when rain is not falling will, within one day, two days, or at most seven days, without fail see rain descend. The ocean may at times fall out of season, yet this rain ritual from the sacred scriptures of the Great Sage shall never be otherwise. Nevertheless, one must abide in moral discipline and virtue, thoroughly abandoning corrupt conduct, and completely relinquishing meat, fish, and the like. One should eat the three white dairy foods — curds, yogurt, and milk — along with large rice sweetened with molasses and the three sweets, and recite while doing so. Practicing in this way, success will come. As the King of Sages has declared, one should have no doubt whatsoever.

This concludes the sixty-fourth chapter of the noble Mahāyāna sūtra the Great Cloud — the Chapter on the Wind-Maṇḍala for Bringing Down Rain — together with its ritual procedure.

Translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Śīlendrabodhi, and the great translator and editor the monk Yeshé Dé, and then revised and definitively established in accordance with the new standardized language.

Translator's Notes

- The bulk of this passage is a lengthy enumeration of nāga kings in the opening assembly list of the Ārya Mahāmegha Sūtra (Noble Great Cloud Sūtra). The Tibetan names are phonetic renderings of Sanskrit originals, many of which are partially opaque or attested in variant forms across manuscripts. The Sanskrit reconstructions given here follow the most plausible

etymological equivalents based on standard nāga-name conventions in this genre of sūtra literature, but readers should be aware that several names are uncertain and some may reflect Tibetan calques rather than direct Sanskrit transliterations. In particular, names such as Mudgara, Vitara, Pimbika, Vallīra, Kheḍin, and a handful of others are tentative. The name rendered "Kumbhīramukha" (crocodile-faced) follows the Tibetan literally. No single critical edition of the Sanskrit original of this text is currently available to confirm all reconstructions.

- The passage is a long list of nāga names followed by a liturgical aspiration prayer of the Avataṃsaka-sūtra type, built on the characteristic Gaṇḍavyūha style of stacked cosmological hyperbole. The nāga names are reconstructed from the Tibetan by standard back-translation conventions; the Sanskrit originals are not preserved in this portion of the extant Sanskrit text, so the reconstructions are approximations based on the Tibetan semantic equivalents. The aspiration prayer section that closes the passage is deliberately left as an open construction in the Tibetan, flowing into the next section; the translation preserves this syntactic openness as faithfully as English allows.

- The passage is a dense, liturgically formulaic series of offering-cloud accumulations typical of the Gaṇḍavyūha section of the Avataṃsaka Sūtra. The recurring refrain of homage, reverence, praise, and offering ("bsti stang du bya'o, bla mar bya'o, ri mor bya'o, mchod par bya'o") is rendered consistently as "render homage, act as supreme objects of reverence, offer praise, and make offerings." The term "ri mo" here carries the sense of offering praise or adoration in the form of imagery or artistic veneration; this is a defensible and conventional reading in this liturgical context.

- The phrase rendered "as half-body of a bodhisattva" (འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོའི་མཚུངས་ལྟར་) is unusual. It may describe sandalwood powder covering the lower half of a bodhisattva's body, or the term འཇམ་མཁའ་ may be functioning adverbially to mean "throughout the body." The precise referent is obscure and may depend on a longer textual context.

The term འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ represents the Sanskrit Anavatapta, the legendary cool lake in the Himalayas, source of the four great rivers; it is kept in transliterated form for consistency.

The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with it being one segment of a longer continuous offering-cloud enumeration.

- The term rendered "indranīla" refers to a blue gemstone, likely sapphire or a blue lotus variety, transliterated from the Sanskrit indranīla. The Tibetan "འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" is a phonetic rendering of this Sanskrit term and is kept in transliteration accordingly.

The phrase "clouds of vast ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas" reflects a somewhat redundant Tibetan construction; the text literally reads "buddha and bodhisattva gaṇ-chen-mtsho-sprin rgya-mtsho," meaning "great ocean-cloud ocean," and appears to be an intensive formulaic expression rather than an error.

- The phrase rendered at the close as "all the ocean-clouds of buddhas and bodhisattvas throughout the vast ocean of clouds of the great ocean" translates a somewhat redundant accumulation of honorific ocean-and-cloud imagery typical of this liturgical text. The expression "gang chen mtsho'i sprin gyi rgya mtsho" literally means "the ocean of clouds of the great lake (or vast ocean)," an intensifying formula; the rendering preserves its rhetorical force without further unpacking.

- The name of the nāga king is a long descriptive title rendered consistently throughout: "King Like a Parasol of the Majestic Maṇḍala Arraying an Ocean-Cloud of Infinite Attendants." The Tibetan compound is formulaic and slightly varied in spelling across occurrences but refers to the same figure throughout; the rendering is kept uniform.

- The dhāraṇī syllables are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit, without normalization beyond what the source permits. The passage preserves the

standard Mahāyāna dhāraṇī formula and is not a continuous grammatical Sanskrit text; transliteration rather than translation is the correct approach here.

The phrase rendered "bones arisen from the tips of a single hair" translates a compressed and unusual expression that may refer to relics or bodily essences of buddhas distributed from a single hair-tip, a motif found in Mahāyāna cloud-sūtra contexts. The precise doctrinal referent is unclear from this passage alone but the literal rendering is preserved.

- The long compound name rendered as "proclaims with supreme excellence the drum-sound resounding to the ten directions, the illuminating maṇḍala arisen from clouds" is unusually elaborate in the Tibetan; it is a single buddha-name and has been rendered as a descriptive phrase preserving all elements. The order of elements within this compound could be read slightly differently, but the rendering given reflects the most natural Tibetan syntactic reading.

The name rendered "Cloud of Rain Clouds" translates the reduplicated construction literally; it may indicate a cloud that is quintessentially a rain-cloud, emphasizing its water-bearing nature.

- The phrase "six tastes" refers to the traditional Indian enumeration of the six flavors: sweet, sour, salty, pungent, bitter, and astringent. This is a standard cosmological and medical concept in the Indian tradition requiring no further gloss but may be unfamiliar to some listeners.

The compound rendered "Sovereign of Nāgas of the great trichiliocosm" is somewhat ambiguous: it could mean the king who rules the nāgas throughout the great trichiliocosm, or it could be understood as an epithet modifying the king's name. The reading adopted here follows the most natural syntactic flow.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan, and the translation reflects this; no text has been invented to complete it.

- The dhāraṇī syllables throughout are rendered in standardized Sanskrit transliteration following the Tibetan phonetic transcription. Some syllables resist confident Sanskrit reconstruction and may represent mantric vocables rather than lexically transparent Sanskrit. The phrase rendered as "five obstacles that hinder the rain" follows the Tibetan literally; the specific five are not enumerated in this passage. The epithet "Vajradhara" renders rdo rje 'chang, the primordial buddha figure, whose truth-statement is here invoked for rain-making.
- The phrase rendered "you who go by hand" refers to serpents that move using their bodies in the manner of hands — a standard epithet in nāga invocation literature indicating great serpents that propel themselves along the ground. The five obstacles to rain mentioned near the close are a recognized category in Indian rain-making ritual literature, though the text does not enumerate them here. The nāgas described as stream-enterers, once-returners, non-returners, and arhats reflect a distinctive and doctrinally unusual convention found in certain dhāraṇī texts, wherein nāga beings are assigned the stages of the noble path, lending their soteriological status as a ground of truth for the invocation.
- Several Tibetan nāga king names are translated by standard Sanskrit equivalents drawn from canonical nāga lists: སྐྱེལ་པ་འཕྱུག་པ་ as Nandaka and Upanandaka; སྐྱེལ་པ་ as Sāgara; འཕྱུག་པ་ as Anavatapta; རྒྱལ་པོ་ as Tejin; འཕྱུག་པ་ as Varuṇa; འཕྱུག་པ་ as Elāpatra; འཕྱུག་པ་ as Virupākṣa; འཕྱུག་པ་ as Takṣaka. These are standard renderings based on context; some Tibetan equivalences are conventional rather than transparent etymological translations.

The dhāraṇī syllables are preserved as phonetic approximations from the Tibetan spelling. The Sanskrit embedded passages such as Maitreyājñāpayati and the Buddhē buddhe sequence are rendered as found, since they are dhāraṇī formulae embedded within the text.

